

One Nation... One Indian... One Honour...



CNN-IBN Indian of the Year 2007, in partnership with Hindustan Times, is an award that recognises extraordinary Indians who have contributed to the society and the country in a calendar year, and in the process help build Brand India. CNN-IBN Indian of the Year 2007 is declared after going through an unparalleled and unquestionable four-tier selection process.

The nominees are shortlisted by the Network18 Editorial board that comprises of Raghav Bhal, Editor Network18, Rajdeep Sardesai, Editor-in-Chief CNN-IBN, Senthil Chengalvarayan, Managing Editor CNBC-TV18, Sanjay Pugalia Editor CNBC Awaaz and Ashutosh Managing Editor of IBN7. The shortlist is then ratified by the jury and then goes into voting. The Eminent Jury comprises of Soli Sorabjee, Deepak Parekh, Nandan Nilekani, Shobhana Bhartia, Geet Sethi, Mohan Lal & Kiran Bedi. Here, while the citizens get to vote where the nominees popularity gets gauged, there is also an electoral college consisting of contemporary Indian leaders from various walks of life, who also vote. The electoral college vote, which represents the intelligentsia of the country, gets equal weightage as the popular vote. There are six winners from the following categories - Politics, Business, Entertainment,

Sports, Public Service and Global Indian. One of the six winners is anointed the CNN-IBN Indian of the Year 2007. This is the culmination of a 2 month process, which is pan India and truly multimedia, including new age media communities like youtube, secondlife, orkut, facebook...

There were two thought provoking town hall discussions conducted by Rajdeep Sardesai in Mumbai and Bengaluru, which got the debate started on identifying the winners. This was taken to another level, when all the four news channels of Network18, the country's largest and most influential news network, lead by the respective editors went on to debate "Who will be the one?" from the category winners.

The Grand Finale, a fantastic event of a scale never seen anywhere in India, and was attended by the who's who of the capital, who came from all fields of work to applaud the



success of the extraordinary Indians who were being recognized and awarded, showing the acceptance of this platform as an institution which stands for credibility and substance.



"When I saw every Indian achiever of the year I remembered a famous Thyagaraja Keerthana, Endaro Mahanubhavulu...which means that the great human beings, the great souls, we all salute them! I salute the great event..."

Friends when I see all of you, some young people here; you will ask yourself how all these achievements came... from RK Laxman to Indian of the Year... how did they achieve? It looks to me that they had 4 things in common for all; they had a great aim in life; they went on acquiring knowledge; sweat and hard work; they were not afraid of problems... they defeated all problems and succeeded..."

APJ Abdul Kalam